GLOBAL INTELLIGENCE

Evening Update

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What Changed Today

- **Oil and gas slump on US-Iran talks:** Brent closed near $104.85 a barrel and WTI at $96.36, down about 7.5% (ANSA). Dutch TTF gas fell about 10% to roughly €93/MWh. Reports that Iran's Supreme Leader Khamenei approved talks with Washington drove the move. Trump said a deal "could happen". The war is in its ninth month and Hormuz is still shut.
- **Abu Dhabi talks take shape:** Envoy Steve Witkoff said the US will mediate technical-level Russia-Ukraine talks. He will also meet delegates from France, Germany, the UK, the EU and NATO on security guarantees for Kyiv. The FT calls it the first such US-Russia-Ukraine meeting since February.
- **Russian bombs kill 26 at a Ukrainian aid centre:** Kyiv says at least nine 3,000kg bombs hit a southern village. Zelensky called it "utterly horrific". This is Ukraine's account; Moscow has not confirmed it.
- **US midterms vote today:** The House and a third of the Senate are at stake. Trump closed his campaign at the Lincoln Memorial reflecting pool. An FT poll shows a large majority disapprove of his handling of inflation.
- **AI financing strain deepens:** Oracle is near a $10bn share sale at an 11% discount, per Bloomberg. Anthropic disclosed about $900bn of AI spending commitments (FT) ahead of its Nasdaq listing.
- **China moves to slow the yuan's rally:** The People's Bank of China (PBOC) will raise the foreign-exchange reserve requirement ratio from 15 November. The offshore yuan weakened on the news.
- **US strips South Africa and Rwanda of AGOA access:** Both lose duty-free access under the African Growth and Opportunity Act. This comes a week after US sanctions on Rwanda's defence ministry.
- **Cold-chain hacks reach Italy:** Two Italian food firms were hit. The national cybersecurity agency (ACN) has called in retailers and food-chain operators.

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Europe & Italy

Italian spread and yields ease with oil

The BTP-Bund spread closed almost 6 points lower at 113 basis points. The 10-year BTP yield fell almost 9 points to 4.42% (ANSA). Cheaper energy helps Italy, a large gas importer, and reduces pressure for more ECB hikes. Milan rose 0.9%, Paris 0.98%, Frankfurt 0.63% and London 0.29% (ANSA).

Watch: Eurozone October flash inflation on Wednesday. The September rate was 3.8%.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA

Cold-chain cyberattacks reach Italy

A Tuscan catering company and an Emilian frozen-food company were targeted, Il Sole 24 Ore reports. The ACN has stepped up monitoring and convened large retailers and food-chain operators. The attacks follow suspected hacks that pushed freezer temperatures up in six European countries. FT's newsletter says supermarket freezers overheated in a fresh attack. Nobody has been blamed.

Why it matters: Attacks on refrigeration control systems can spoil stock and show how weak operational technology (the systems that run physical equipment) can be in food supply.

Watch: Any attribution, and any ACN guidance to the sector.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore, FT

Italian car market grows, but Stellantis slips

Registrations rose 4.8% in October and 8.3% over ten months (ANSA). Stellantis, counting Leapmotor, fell 5.5% in the month. Its market share dropped to 24.2%.

Why it matters: Italy's largest industrial group is losing share at home even as the market grows.

Source: ANSA

Lagarde's exit and French industrial stress

Bank of France chief Moulin said ECB President Christine Lagarde resigned to start a new chapter in her career (Bloomberg). Our earlier edition reported she leaves on 7 February 2027. Separately, Alstom shares fell 26% after a second profit warning under new chief Martin Sion. The group also set out a plan to cut €2bn of debt (FT). Alstom has large Italian rail operations, and the fall adds to market worry about French industry.

Watch: European leaders' search for Lagarde's successor.

Sources: Bloomberg, FT

Greece buys KC-390 transports

Greece signed a government-to-government deal with Portugal for three Embraer KC-390 aircraft, with options for up to six more (Breaking Defense). The Brazilian-built jet is a European choice over US rivals.

Source: Breaking Defense

World

United States: midterms and Iran

Voters decide all 435 House seats and about a third of the Senate today. Trump spoke at the Lincoln Memorial reflecting pool, attacked Democratic candidates and said an Iran deal "could happen". An FT poll shows a big majority disapprove of his handling of inflation. Voto Latino's Maria Teresa Kumar says Latino voters in Texas's Rio Grande Valley are returning to Democrats over costs, tariffs and immigration enforcement. That is one advocate's view.

For Europe & Italy: European diplomats fear NATO or troop cuts after a Republican loss. That is a fear, not a decision.

Sources: Bloomberg, FT

Middle East: oil falls on the prospect of talks

Bloomberg says Brent steadied after its near-8% fall. The US and Iran signalled willingness to talk, and no ceasefire is in place. Oil moved on signals, not on any reopening of the strait.

Sources: Bloomberg, ANSA

Russia and Ukraine: diplomacy alongside heavy strikes

Witkoff said talks will be at technical level. The earlier edition put the meeting at 6-10 November. Kyiv says Russian bombs killed 26 people at an aid centre in a southern village. Washington approved a $2.1bn Patriot missile sale to Ukraine, but delivery is not expected until a couple of years into the 2030s (Defense News). Japan Times reports Russia's army is suffering record losses while its land gains slip. The source's analysis was not independently verified here.

Russia's statistics agency Rosstat confirmed a cyberattack claimed by Belarusian and pro-Ukrainian hackers. Fake nuclear warnings went out on Sunday after the air-alert apps in Ukraine and Russia were hacked, and neither government has said who was responsible.

Sources: ANSA, BBC, Defense News, The Record, BBC

China: curbing the yuan's rise

The PBOC will raise the FX reserve ratio (the share of foreign currency banks must hold in reserve) from 15 November. That cuts the supply of dollars to markets and slows the yuan's rise. The offshore yuan weakened. Vice Premier He Lifeng pledged support for Hong Kong's open economy and more offshore yuan liquidity. Apple's China sales missed estimates.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Indo-Pacific

North Korea denied the FBI's accusation that it stole $6.3bn from Binance. It also reported a cluster-warhead cruise-missile test within days of a ballistic one (Handelsblatt). In Australia, a rights group begins a High Court challenge to the under-16 social media ban.

Sources: BBC, Handelsblatt, BBC

Africa

The US removed South Africa and Rwanda from AGOA, citing trade barriers and national security (FT). Pretoria had lobbied hard to keep access. In South Africa, a man was found guilty of stealing cash from a farm owned by President Ramaphosa, part of the "Farmgate" scandal that has left him in an impeachment saga.

Sources: Bloomberg, FT, BBC

Latin America

A bomb attack in western Colombia killed four, including a baby. It appears to have targeted a military base, and no group has claimed it. Brazil's Mercado Bitcoin confirmed a cyberattack, with over $46m reported leaving the platform.

Sources: BBC, The Record

Markets Close

Energy drove the day. Brent settled near $104.8 and WTI at $96.4. Calculations differ on the size of the fall: ANSA has Brent down 7.6%, while the data feed shows about 11%. Dutch TTF gas fell about 10% to €93.45/MWh. The trigger was the prospect of US-Iran talks. That is market pricing of diplomacy, not a reopening of Hormuz.

Europe: ANSA reported closes up: Paris +0.98%, Frankfurt +0.63%, London +0.29% and Milan +0.9%. Delayed quote data show different daily moves, so treat the size of these with caution. The BTP-Bund spread tightened to 113 bp and the BTP yield fell to 4.42%.

US: Stocks opened higher, with the Dow up 0.76%. The last quotes show the S&P 500 at 7,541 (-0.5%) and the Nasdaq 100 at 27,990 (-1.4%). The VIX rose to 21.15. Oracle's planned $10bn share sale at an 11% discount weighed on sentiment. Apple's results beat estimates but China missed.

Other assets: - The US 10-year yield was 4.89%. - EUR/USD was about 1.12. - Gold was $3,957 (+1.5%). - Bitcoin was $77,090 (-1.5%). - The offshore yuan weakened after the PBOC move.

Tomorrow: Midterm results and Eurozone flash inflation are the main drivers. - Airlines, chemicals and utilities are the most sensitive to oil and gas headlines. - Alstom, and French credit more broadly, remain exposed to the profit warning. - Oil could rebound if talks stall.

Sources: ANSA, Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Technology, Defence & Space

Apple beats on revenue; China is the weak spot

Fiscal fourth-quarter revenue rose 12% to $114.5bn against a $113.5bn consensus (Bloomberg). Growth slowed from 16% in the June quarter. It is the first report since John Ternus became CEO. IDC says the smartphone market fell 21% in the third quarter, while Apple's shipments fell only 4%.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg

AI funding: Oracle's discounted raise and Anthropic's IPO

Oracle is near a $10bn share sale at an 11% discount. Anthropic has named eight firms, including Macquarie and CommSec, for an Australian retail offer ahead of its Nasdaq debut. The FT says it has disclosed about $900bn of AI spending commitments. Other reports I found put the figure lower, so treat the total as depending on how commitments are counted.

Why it matters: Raising cash on this scale shows how heavily AI build-outs rely on capital markets.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, FT

Cyber: UK warning on AI-driven attacks

The head of Britain's National Cyber Security Centre will warn that Chinese and Russian AI-enabled cyberattacks will be routine by 2028 (FT). Defences, especially for critical infrastructure, are inadequate, in his view. Meanwhile, Michigan State University's incident was claimed by the BYOD ransomware gang. US industry groups want the cyber threat-sharing law's liability protections extended through 2035.

Sources: FT, The Record, Defense One

Defence and space

The Pentagon approved a $2.1bn Patriot sale to Ukraine, with deliveries years away. Oshkosh partnered with Grid Aero to build large Lifter drones at scale. NASA opened media accreditation for Northrop Grumman's Cygnus resupply mission to the space station, launching on a Falcon 9 in November. The FT says Canada's Telesat plan for a Starlink rival depends on Musk's rockets.

Sources: Defense News, Breaking Defense, NASA, FT

Overnight & Tomorrow

- **US midterm results:** Polls close through the evening in the US, with results overnight and into Wednesday. Watch for contested races and legal challenges, which the administration has prepared.
- **Asia:** Watch the yuan fixing and offshore yuan after the PBOC reserve-ratio move. The Nikkei and Taiex fell on Monday, so tech sentiment is in focus.
- **Iran:** Look for any confirmation of talks, a venue or a date, and whether tanker attacks continue.
- **Oil:** Brent is near $105 after a heavy fall, so the market is sensitive to any stalling of diplomacy.
- **Eurozone:** The October flash inflation estimate is due Wednesday, after September's 3.8%. A high reading would back the ECB's December hike.
- **Ukraine:** The Abu Dhabi round is reported for 6-10 November, with Witkoff also meeting Europeans on guarantees.
- **Corporate:** Oracle's share sale pricing and Anthropic's IPO roadshow.
- **Later this week:** The Bank of England decision and US jobs data.

Sources: FT, ANSA

Markets Dashboard

Europe	Last	Day	Week
Euro Stoxx 50	6,131.31	-1.22%	+1.04%
FTSE MIB (Italy)	49,501.00	-1.00%	+1.94%
DAX (Germany)	25,818.21	-0.85%	+2.53%
CAC 40 (France)	7,969.42	-0.01%	+2.40%
IBEX 35 (Spain)	18,652.90	-1.09%	-1.77%
FTSE 100 (UK)	10,729.80	+0.07%	+0.37%

Americas	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,541.40	-0.51%	-1.76%
Nasdaq 100	27,989.82	-1.39%	-4.38%
VIX (US volatility)	21.15	+8.91%	+15.01%
Bovespa (Brazil)	167,921.80	-0.00%	-4.92%

Asia	Last	Day	Week
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	63,290.11	-2.12%	+0.95%
CSI 300 (China)	3,990.47	–	–
Hang Seng (Hong Kong)	23,440.43	+0.63%	+0.98%
KOSPI (South Korea)	5,713.92	-0.29%	+4.47%
Taiex (Taiwan)	44,593.32	-1.37%	-3.15%
Nifty 50 (India)	23,053.10	+0.51%	+2.00%

Rates	Last	Day	Week
US 10Y yield (%)	4.8940	-0.71%	-1.85%
US 2Y yield (%)	4.7750	+4.42%	+0.53%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1191	+0.30%	+0.15%
EUR/GBP	0.8345	+0.12%	-0.34%
EUR/CHF	0.9165	-0.39%	-0.89%
EUR/CNY	7.4530	+0.29%	+0.00%
US Dollar Index (DXY)	101.80	-0.08%	-0.16%
USD/JPY	157.89	+0.14%	+0.23%
USD/CNH	6.6608	–	–
USD/RUB	80.89	+0.27%	+0.12%
USD/INR	94.90	-0.26%	-0.03%
USD/BRL	5.4366	+0.03%	+1.19%
USD/TRY	49.99	+0.05%	+0.42%
Bitcoin ($)	77,090.44	-1.48%	-5.14%

Commodities	Last	Day	Week
Brent ($/bbl)	104.71	-10.99%	-9.58%
WTI ($/bbl)	96.59	-7.23%	-5.08%
Dutch TTF gas (EUR/MWh)	93.45	-10.10%	-3.34%
Gold ($/oz)	3,956.60	+1.48%	-2.03%
Silver ($/oz)	50.31	+2.48%	-7.01%
Copper ($/lb)	6.5170	+0.91%	+0.14%
Wheat (c/bu)	606.25	+0.46%	-1.58%

Delayed exchange quotes, last daily close (Yahoo Finance). Prices, not policy facts.

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